

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠4

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥4

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠5

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦A

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 8 3
♥ K
♦ K 10 8 5 4 3
♣ Q 10 2

♠ A K 9
♥ A J 8 2
♦ A 6
♣ A K 9 3



♠ 6 5 4
♥ 9 6 4 3
♦ Q J 9
♣ J 7 6

♠ Q J 7 2
♥ Q 10 7 5
♦ 7 2
♣ 8 5 4

NORTH opens 2♣ and SOUTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

NORTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

SOUTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead.

NORTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So NORTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and SOUTH bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♠4			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A Q 7 4

♠ 5 4 2
♥ J 10 9 7 6
♦ 2
♣ 10 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ K J 3

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 4 3
♦ Q J 10 9 5
♣ 9 6

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by East			
Lead: ♥4			

EAST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to WEST's 2♣ opening bid.

WEST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

EAST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 9 5
 ♥ J 4
 ♦ J 10 8 5 3
 ♣ J 10 4

♠ 7 2

♥ 9 7 5 3

♦ Q 7 4 2

♣ Q 9 3



♠ 10 4 3

♥ Q 6

♦ K 9 6

♣ A K 7 5 2

♠ A K Q 8 6

♥ A K 10 8 2

♦ A

♣ 8 6

SOUTH has both Majors and enough points to open 2♣. NORTH, with 4 points, responds with a negative 2♦.

SOUTH first bids her higher ranking suit, 2♠. NORTH is too strong for second negative, he bids 2NT.

SOUTH now shows her second suit, 3♥.

NORTH is happy to bid the game in ♥s.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 2
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ K 7 5
 ♣ K Q 10

♠ 10 5 4

♥ 10 3

♦ 10 9 2

♣ A 9 8 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7 3

♥ 9 8 2

♦ A Q J 8 6

♣ J 2

♠ J 9 8 6

♥ J 7 6 4

♦ 4 3

♣ 6 4 3

West

2♣

3NT

All Pass

6NT by West

Lead: ♠5

North

Pass

Pass

East

3♦

6NT

South

Pass

WEST has a balanced hand with 23 points. He opens 2♣ and expects to rebid 2NT.

EAST has 12 points so makes a positive response in her best suit. Since that suit is ♦s she must jump to the 3-level.

WEST now describes his balanced, minimum hand by bidding 3NT.

EAST bids 6NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 34 points.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 8 5

♥ 10 8 6

♦ 10 7

♣ 10 8 5 4

♠ K 6

♥ A K Q J 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K Q J



♠ 4 3

♥ 4 3

♦ A 9 6 4 3

♣ 9 7 6 2

♠ A 10 9 7 2

♥ 9 7 5

♦ 8 5 2

♣ A 3

SOUTH, with 9 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

NORTH bids her ♥s and SOUTH agrees the trump suit with a 4♥ bid.

NORTH thinks there is a slam, so she invokes Blackwood. Hearing that SOUTH holds two Aces she bids 6NT. She could also have bid 6♥ but 6NT scores a little more.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♦ A			